**AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)**
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A Approved ? Effective 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

# Transnet Foundation × ASCO

## KwaZulu-Natal Community Biodiversity and Green Livelihoods Programme

**Requested CSI investment:** R100,000

**Proposed implementation area:** Richards Bay-Umhlathuze, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to local needs assessment, permissions and Transnet/community stakeholder confirmation

**Prepared:** October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

## Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Transnet Foundation** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **KwaZulu-Natal Community Biodiversity and Green Livelihoods Programme**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** KwaZulu-Natal Community Biodiversity and Green Livelihoods Programme in Richards Bay-Umhlathuze, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to local needs assessment, permissions and Transnet/community stakeholder confirmation, benefiting Proposed: residents and community-based participants in the Richards Bay-Umhlathuze area, prioritising unemployed/ underemployed youth, women and vulnerable households; final numbers and eligibility to be confirmed through a baseline assessment and stakeholder consultation. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Transnet Foundation's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

**What ASCO is requesting**
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

**What the funding would enable**
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

## About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

**Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu**
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
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# The proposed project

**Project title**
KwaZulu-Natal Community Biodiversity and Green Livelihoods Programme

**Implementation period**
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

**Location**
Richards Bay-Umhlathuze, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to local needs assessment, permissions and Transnet/community stakeholder confirmation

**Target beneficiaries**
Proposed: residents and community-based participants in the Richards Bay-Umhlathuze area, prioritising unemployed/underemployed youth, women and vulnerable households; final numbers and eligibility to be confirmed through a baseline assessment and stakeholder consultation.

## Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: engage 40 local participants in practical environmental stewardship, safety and work-readiness training.
- Proposed: clear and manage 5 hectares of priority invasive vegetation, subject to ecological approvals and landowner/municipal permissions.
- Proposed: establish or restore 2 community demonstration sites with indigenous planting and maintenance plans.
- Proposed: deliver 6 community/environment education sessions and reach at least 200 learners or residents.
- Proposed: create 10 short-term paid work opportunities or stipends for local participants, subject to budget and compliance.
- Proposed: submit baseline, monthly activity, beneficiary, financial and endline impact reports with a sustainability plan.

## Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

## Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

## Why Transnet Foundation?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

### Verified company context

- Transnet identifies the Transnet Foundation as its corporate social investment arm and says it supports developmental initiatives across South Africa through partnerships.
- The Foundation's stated people-centred focus areas are health, education and livelihoods; its objectives also include support for vulnerable communities, community well-being, socio-economic transformation, capacity building and employee volunteerism.
- The Foundation's CSI Fund and Fundraising portfolio says it supports NGOs and NPOs through sponsorships and donations when funding is available, and seeks alignment with development objectives.
- The official CSI Fund page states that sponsorships and donations are currently under a moratorium because of company cost-containment measures; it lists tfsponsorshipsanddonations@transnet.net for sponsorship opportunities and partnership information.
- The official funding criteria require, among other things, alignment with the Foundation operating model, community-development/social-priority relevance, impact accountability, and a clear sustainability plan; administrative criteria include legal DSD NPO registration, at least one year of existence, a bank account held for more than one year, SARS tax-clearance certification, a BEE certificate, and serving at least 75% Black beneficiaries.
- The official Transnet National Ports Authority report documents environmental stewardship at KwaZulu-Natal-related ports, including alien/invasive-plant clearance at Richards Bay and gazetted estuary-management plans for Durban Bay and Richards Bay-Umhlathuze; it also describes CSI as community development aligned with the SDGs and South Africa's National Development Plan.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

## Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

| Budget category | Indicative amount | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Direct programme implementation | R60,000 | Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project. |
| Participant transport and access | R8,000 | Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records. |
| Safety equipment and participant welfare | R6,000 | PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements. |
| Educational and mobilisation materials | R8,000 | Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication. |
| Monitoring, evaluation and reporting | R7,000 | Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting. |
| Volunteer/project coordination | R7,000 | Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management. |
| Reasonable administration | R4,000 | Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads. |
| **Total requested CSI investment** | **R100,000** | **Equals the proposed request.** |

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

## Partnership options

**Option A — Full project funding**
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

**Option B — Partial project funding**
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

**Option C — Multi-phase partnership**
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

**In-kind or technical support**
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

## Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

## Initial contact route

Official route: email tfsponsorshipsanddonations@transnet.net for sponsorship/partnership information; general Transnet contact is enquiries@transnet.net and +27 11 308 3000. The official page currently says sponsorships and donations are under moratorium, so an application may not be accepted or processed until the moratorium changes.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

## Important conditions and open questions

- Transnet's official CSI Fund page says sponsorships and donations are currently under a moratorium due to cost containment; funding availability and timing are therefore uncertain.
- No official source reviewed confirms that Transnet Foundation will fund this specific ASCO concept, KwaZulu-Natal project, or a R100,000 request.
- ASCO's NPC/PBO status does not by itself establish compliance with every stated funding criterion. Confirm DSD NPO registration, one-year existence, bank-account age, SARS tax clearance, BEE certificate, beneficiary composition and proposal-format requirements before applying.
- The reviewed official pages do not establish a dedicated open environmental application window or a current online application form; the official route appears to be the stated sponsorship email, subject to the moratorium.
- Do not claim completed project results, existing Transnet partnerships, company commitments, or Section 18A approval.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

## Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Transnet Foundation** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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## Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.transnet.net/TransnetFoundation
2. https://www.transnet.net/RenderPage.aspx?id=4348464
3. https://www.transnet.net/getFile.ashx?id=3386
4. https://www.transnet.net/getFile.ashx?id=727

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.